is an experimental science," wrote *Physical Review*'s editor in chief in 1973, Samuel Goudsmit, the Dutch physicist who had led the Alsos mission in World War II. "No physical theory is significant unless it can be related to experimental data." (Clauser pointed out that these restrictions would have barred *Physical Review* from publishing Bohr's response to the EPR paper, as they had done forty years earlier.) There were only a handful of journals that would accept papers on quantum foundations, among them *Foundations of Physics,* where Zeh's paper had finally ended up.

To solve this problem, the quantum underground founded a new ersatz "journal" called *Epistemological Letters.* Billing itself as a permanent written symposium on "hidden variables and quantum uncertainty," this samizdat was hand-typed, published by mimeograph, and overseen by an informal collection of editors, including Shimony. "*Epistemological Letters* are not a scientific journal in the ordinary sense," it boldly declared on the back cover of every issue (and referring to itself in the third person plural). "They want to create a basis for an open and informal discussion allowing confrontation and ripening of ideas before publishing in some adequate journal." In its pages, the verboten was discussed: the measurement problem, the true meaning of Bell's theorem, and more. Papers by Bell, Shimony, Clauser, Zeh, d'Espagnat, and Karl Popper appeared in its pages over its eleven-year run. "The variety of the contributions and the vigor of the debates showed that the purpose [of the journal] was very well accomplished," Shimony said later. "The reputation of the written symposium spread rapidly, and many people throughout the world wrote to be added to the list of recipients."

For the first time since 1935, there was a cohesive community of physicists working on the foundations of quantum physics. They had a shared theoretical and experimental research program, they had a journal of their own (such as it was), and they even had occasional conferences. But it was still not safe to publicly identify as a member of that group, especially for young researchers—at least not yet.

In 1974, a young French physicist named Alain Aspect arrived at the